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PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI

namics. This is because of growing disposable income and buyers' propensity to upgrade after the Covid-19 pandemic.

WITH SOCIAL MEDIA and global exposure, luxury demand is not restricted to Delhi and Mumbai. In September, Amar Ohri, proprietor of Hyderabad's Tansen restaurant, introduced the Jewel of Tansen cocktail, priced at ₹9,999. "We sold 12 of them in the first few weeks," he says. Drive down Hyderabad's high street, Road No. 10, and you are likely to be stuck in a traffic snarl of luxury cars, as the city's well-to-do shop at designer stores such as Sabyasachi, Falguni & Shane and Ritu Kumar. Brands do trunk shows in Ahmedabad, Ludhiana and Coimbatore; and on Tata CLiQ Luxury, 55% revenue comes from non-metro markets.

"By foraying into the e-commerce space, luxury brands are able to reach out to consumers across the country, and this has encouraged the adoption and growth of luxury way beyond the metros," says Gopal Asthana, CEO of online retailer Tata CLiQ. Neeraj Walia, MD and CEO of luxury goods maker Montblanc India, says it services 329 cities through Tata Cliq Luxury, with leather accessories, pens and watches. "The younger generation... [is] into journaling and love fountain pens," says Walia.

That's important. India is home to around 322 million millennials. Luxury brands are focussing on millennials and the GenZ due to their inclination towards aspirational spending and a willingness to invest in unique experiences, says Euro-monitor's Roberts. Its 'Voice of the Consumer: Lifestyles Survey 2023' says more than 75% of millennials in India say they are looking for tailored curated experiences. "Their rising capacity to spend on luxury items teamed with wealth expansion, will be a key driver for market growth," she says.

The expanding luxury market has led to brands such as Gucci and Louis Vuitton opening new stores at Jio World Plaza in Mumbai, and new ones such as menswear brand Brioni and shoe brand Aquazzura entering India. Swiss luxury chocolate brand Läderach, which opened its first store in Delhi last year, has

seen 5x-plus growth. Even Indian luxury brands such as Zoya, the jewellery brand from the House of Tata, are expanding. "In terms of growth, Zoya has experienced an impressive CAGR of 40% over the past four years, bringing our revenue close to ₹300 crore, which will increase further with the addition of five more stores this year—15 stores in 15 years," says Ajoy Chawla, CEO-Jewellery Division, Titan Company.

With a growing economy and an appetite for luxury, all eyes are on India as luxury brands vie for growth. **BT**

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